Spring and Summer News

This bulletin collects the news from the allotment society for the last three months. It is printed for members who do not use email, and copies are left in the shed by the main gate for anyone who wants one.

The water supply was turned on again in early April after the repairs to the main pipe. Members are asked to use watering cans rather than hoses during dry spells, so that the plots at the far end of the site still have enough pressure in the evenings.

The plant sale raised more money than in any previous year. Thanks go to everyone who grew seedlings, baked cakes or helped on the day. The money will pay for a new lock on the gate and fresh gravel for the main path.

Plots and Paths

Several plots changed hands this season. New members are welcome to ask the committee for advice, and the society keeps a small library of gardening books in the shed which anyone may borrow for a month at a time.

The marker posts at the end of each row have been repainted, as shown in Figure 1, so that visitors can find the plot numbers more easily. Please do not move the posts when digging, and report any that have been damaged.

The autumn meeting will be held in the village hall on the first Saturday of October. The agenda includes the election of officers, the accounts for the year and a proposal to build a second compost bay near the western hedge.

Figure 1: A repainted marker post

Coming Up

Members who have surplus produce are reminded that the food bank in the town accepts fresh vegetables on Tuesday and Friday mornings. Last year the society gave more than two

hundred kilograms of potatoes, beans and squash.

Finally, the committee would like to thank the retiring treasurer for eleven years of careful work. A small presentation will take place after the autumn meeting, and all members are invited to stay for tea.

From the Plots

Plot twelve produced the heaviest marrow anyone can remember. Its grower credits a load of manure from the riding stables and a great deal of rainwater collected from the shed roof in old barrels.

Slugs were a problem everywhere in the wet weeks of June. Several members tried beer traps, copper tape and nightly patrols with a torch, and the patrols, though tiring, seemed to work best of all.

The beehives at the northern end have done well. The keeper expects a good harvest in September and will sell jars at the autumn meeting, with the proceeds going towards a new roof for the shed.

A family of foxes has moved into the bramble patch behind plot thirty. They are welcome to stay, but members are asked to keep netting secure and to close the gate behind them, especially in the evening.

The communal tool store now has a sign-out sheet. Please write down what you borrow and return it clean, because several spades went missing over the summer and one fork came back with a broken handle.

Seed swapping will happen on the last Sunday of November in the shed. Bring labelled envelopes with the variety and the year, and take home something new to try next season.